

are intent upon growing! Yes, this program has been around for nearly 50 years, and hardly anyone knows about it.

The great news is that the program doesn't cater to any specific facet of business. So, regardless of what your company does, you may be eligible to take advantage!

Need some start-up money to get things going? Not a problem. How about some expert management assistance to take you to the next level? You got it. The SBIC can cover you, so don't waste any time in applying. Go to [www.sba.gov/aboutsba/sbaprograms/inv/index.html](http://www.sba.gov/aboutsba/sbaprograms/inv/index.html). The potential dollars are encouraging. The SBIC funding for small businesses includes \$10 billion from the government and private funding of over \$12 billion.

The SBIC site likes to share their success stories and reading them is very inspirational. Check out [http://www.sba.gov/aboutsba/sbaprograms/inv/INV\\_SUCCESS\\_STORIES.html](http://www.sba.gov/aboutsba/sbaprograms/inv/INV_SUCCESS_STORIES.html) and see if you are in awe, as I was. They state it perfectly: "The most exciting potential of an SBIC investment is how it can turn one small company into a great success story." Your company could join the ranks of big names (who once were small) like America Online, Apple Computer, Federal Express, Gymboree, Jenny Craig Inc, Staples, and many, many more. There is free money for your business. Who knows, you could be "small potatoes" today, and in the future, you could join the list that contains the likes of Outback Steakhouse, Restoration Hardware, and Costco.

There are hundreds of state agencies with money to help your business. All you have to do is reach out to them. Also available to you are local programs. Your city, county, and even local organizations all offer assistance in the way of grants and low-interest loans, and venture capital as well.

Let's take a state like New York. Growing a business in New York can be tough – especially when it's technology-based. With all the fierce competition out there, it can be daunting for a business owner who hopes to transform the market with cutting-edge technologies. That is exactly why the Small Business Technology Investment Fund Program (SBTIF) exists.

Free money can change everything. Watch your business soar to heights you never imagined – all because of the venture capital you